Brainstorming a semester-long progression

PROMPT

Act as an instructional designer specialising in language teaching in blended environments (synchronous and asynchronous). You are well versed in theories of intrinsic motivation (Deci and Ryan, self-determination theory), the principles of second language acquisition (SLA), the neuroscience of learning, and active and game-based teaching approaches that have a concrete impact in the professional world. Your goal: to create a complete, coherent and pragmatic course architecture for a semester-long course.

I would like to design a [LANGUAGE] course on the theme of [THEME]. If you are missing any information, ask me your questions first. Then give me 7 immersive scenarios that foster intrinsic motivation, with a rationale for each. Stop there and wait until I have chosen a scenario before producing the deliverables.

INSTITUTIONAL CONTEXT AND TARGET AUDIENCE

Institutional setting: [EXAMPLE: French university, languages for students of other disciplines (LANSAD), semester 2 of a first-year history degree]

Students' level: [EXAMPLE: CEFR A2+]

Number of students: [EXAMPLE: 30]

Group heterogeneity: [EXAMPLE: Very mixed; some have already lived in immersion (C1), others have never spoken the language (A1)]

Motivational profile: [EXAMPLE: Mainly extrinsic motivation (attendance at LANSAD classes is compulsory). Little emotional connection with the language.]

Technological context: [EXAMPLE: All have access to a computer and the internet. Minimal Moodle skills (compulsory institutional platform)]

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

[EXAMPLE: Self-determination theory (Deci and Ryan). Priorities: student autonomy + progressive competence + minimal but genuine social connection. Task-based approach (Ellis, CEFR). Priority on spoken production. Active learning (role play, debate, problem solving). No purely lecture-based teaching. Game-based learning (using game mechanics to foster a state of flow, as distinct from gamification)]

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Here are my learning objectives. Check that they are clear and measurable (Bloom's taxonomy as revised by Anderson and Krathwohl), rephrase them if needed and add to them to reach 3 to 5 objectives.

Recommended format: By the end of the semester, students will be able to… [ACTION VERB + CONTENT + CONTEXT]

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Objective 1: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the semester, students will be able to take part in a group conversation on a current-affairs topic, sustaining the interaction for at least 10 minutes, using expressions of concession and markers of disagreement.]

Objective 2: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the semester, students will be able to write an argumentative text (short essay) in English, at B1 level, on a topic related to their discipline (history).]

Objective 3: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the semester, students will be able to summarise, orally or in writing, a 5–10-minute podcast or video in English, conveying at least 4 of its 5 main ideas.]

FORMAT, CONSTRAINTS AND ASSESSMENT

Total teaching hours: [EXAMPLE: 18 contact hours + 24–36 hours of asynchronous work (2–3 hours per week)]

Number of weeks: [EXAMPLE: 12 weeks (January–May)]

Synchronous/asynchronous rhythm: [EXAMPLE: Blended, 1.5 hours by video call per week (Wednesday 2 pm) + 2–3 hours of asynchronous work per week. Pedagogical rationale: synchronous interaction for speaking (real-time feedback needed), asynchronous for writing (reflection + revision).]

Available resources: [EXAMPLE: Moodle, Zoom, Genially licence, free tools.]

Assessment format: [EXAMPLE: Continuous assessment: participation in synchronous role plays, written portfolio, individual oral project, reflective self-assessment]

Assessment frequency and milestones: [EXAMPLE: 4 formal assessment milestones (weeks 3, 6, 9, 12) + informal weekly feedback. No final exam.]

Assessment weighting: [EXAMPLE: Synchronous participation 20% + written portfolio 30% + individual oral project 25% + reflective self-assessment 25%]

ROLE OF AI IN THE COURSE

Student support: [EXAMPLE: An asynchronous AI tutor (e.g. a chatbot on Moodle) to answer factual questions. No personalised feedback on written work (given by the teacher).]

EXPECTED DELIVERABLES

Complete course architecture: overall scenario, weekly plan (objectives per week + synchronous activities + asynchronous activities)

Content modules: [NUMBER, EXAMPLE: 6] detailed modules

Learning activities: at least [NUMBER, EXAMPLE: 3] activities per week, including synchronous and asynchronous interaction

Teacher resources: facilitation guides, Zoom scripts, time management

Assessment tools: grids, rubrics, marking schemes

Produce these deliverables one at a time, in this order, and wait for my approval before moving on to the next.

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VALIDATION CRITERIA

Pedagogical coherence: [EXAMPLE: Every activity must serve the objectives. Activities must genuinely get students speaking/writing. No “filler”. Every interaction must count.]

Adaptability to mixed levels: [EXAMPLE: Offer difficulty variants for each activity, covering all the levels given above.]

Assessment frequency in line with teaching hours: [EXAMPLE: No assessment every week (otherwise students are paralysed by the workload).]

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